

MOCK TEST 📅

Hobbies & Free Time

Face-to-face interview · Speaking only · 11–14 minutes · Topic: Hobbies

01

🗣️ PART 1 · Introduction & interview · 4–5 minutes

The examiner asks about familiar topics. Aim for 2–3 sentences per answer.

FRAME A – HOBBIES

- 1 Do you have a hobby? What is it?
- 2 When did you first become interested in it?
- 3 Do you prefer hobbies you can do alone or with other people?
- 4 Is there a hobby you would like to take up in the future?

FRAME B – WEEKENDS

- 5 What did you do last weekend?
- 6 Are your weekends usually busy or relaxing?
- 7 Did you have more free time as a child than you do now?
- 8 Do you ever feel guilty about doing nothing in your free time?

📝 PART 2 · Long turn · 1 min preparation + 1–2 min talk

Describe a hobby that you enjoy and have done for a long time.

You should say:

- ▶ what the hobby is
 - ▶ when and how you started it
 - ▶ how much time you spend on it
- and explain why you still enjoy it.

❓ Rounding-off question: *Do your friends or family share this hobby?*

✍️ Your 1-minute notes (key words only)

🗣️ PART 3 · Two-way discussion · 4–5 minutes

Abstract questions linked to Part 2. Give opinions, reasons, comparisons and speculation.

THEME 1 – HOBBIES AND SOCIETY

- 1 Why do you think some people have no hobbies at all?
- 2 How have popular hobbies changed compared with your parents' generation?
- 3 Should employers encourage their staff to have hobbies? Why?

THEME 2 – HOBBIES AND MONEY

- 4 Is it a good idea to turn a hobby into a job?
- 5 Why are some hobbies, like golf or sailing, so expensive?
- 6 Should governments pay for free public facilities such as parks and sports centres?

★ MODEL ANSWERS · Band 8 level

Part 1, Q3 – alone or with others?

Honestly, it depends on my mood. After a long day in the lab I'd rather unwind on my own, maybe with a novel, but at weekends I'm much more sociable, so I tend to go for team activities like five-a-side football.

Part 1, Q8 – feeling guilty?

Occasionally, yes. As a postgraduate student there's always another paper to read, so switching off doesn't come naturally. That said, I've learnt that a lazy Sunday actually makes me far more productive on Monday.

Part 3, Q4 – turning a hobby into a job

I think it's a double-edged sword. On the one hand, you'd be doing something you genuinely love, which is a huge motivation. On the other hand, once there's pressure to earn money from it, the activity can stop being an escape and start feeling like a chore. So I'd say it works best for people who can keep a clear boundary between the two, perhaps by keeping one small part of the hobby purely for fun.

✂️ **Try to use in this mock:** take up · get hooked on · unwind after a long day · a great outlet for stress · I've been into it since... · lose track of time · it's not everyone's cup of tea

MOCK TEST

Games, Strategy & Creative Hobbies

Face-to-face interview · Speaking only · 11–14 minutes · Topic: Hobbies

02

PART 1 · Introduction & interview · 4–5 minutes

The examiner asks about familiar topics. Aim for 2–3 sentences per answer.

FRAME A – GAMES

- 1 Did you play board games or card games as a child?
- 2 Do you prefer video games or traditional games? Why?
- 3 Do you like games that involve luck or games that involve skill?
- 4 Do you think playing games is a waste of time for adults?

FRAME B – CREATIVITY

- 5 Do you consider yourself a creative person?
- 6 Have you ever made something by hand, such as a painting or a model?
- 7 Would you like to learn a musical instrument?
- 8 Do you share things you create on social media?

PART 2 · Long turn · 1 min preparation + 1–2 min talk

Describe a game or activity you enjoy that involves strategy or working with other people.

You should say:

- ▶ what the game or activity is
 - ▶ who you usually do it with
 - ▶ what skills it requires
- and explain what it has taught you.

? Rounding-off question: *Are you usually the winner?*

 **Your 1-minute notes** (key words only)

PART 3 · Two-way discussion · 4–5 minutes

Abstract questions linked to Part 2. Give opinions, reasons, comparisons and speculation.

THEME 1 – COMPETITION AND COOPERATION

- 1 What can children learn from games that require negotiation or teamwork?
- 2 Is competition in hobbies healthy, or does it spoil the fun?
- 3 Why do some people become so emotional when they lose a game?

THEME 2 – TECHNOLOGY AND LEISURE

- 4 How has the internet changed the way people pursue their hobbies?
- 5 Now that computers can beat humans at chess, is the game less meaningful?
- 6 Will people have more or less free time in the future? Why?

★ MODEL ANSWERS · Band 8 level

Part 1, Q3 – luck or skill?

Definitely skill. I find games of pure chance a bit pointless, because nothing you decide really matters. With something like chess, if I lose, I know exactly whose fault it is: mine!

Part 1, Q7 – a musical instrument?

I'd love to, actually. I've always fancied learning the piano, but I suspect it has quite a steep learning curve, so I keep putting it off until I have more free time.

Part 3, Q1 – learning from negotiation games

Quite a lot, I'd argue. Games like Catan or Diplomacy force children to strike deals, make concessions and work out what the other players really want, which are exactly the skills they'll need in the workplace. What's more, because it's only a game, they can experiment with different strategies, and even lose badly, without any real consequences, so it's a safe way to learn how cooperation and competition fit together.

 **Try to use in this mock:** *think a few moves ahead · a sore loser · strike a deal · a friendly rivalry · hands-on · a steep learning curve · it brings out my competitive side*

EXAMINER'S TOOLKIT

Speaking Criteria, Model Answer & Hobby Language

Record yourself, listen back, then mark each criterion honestly.



HOW YOU ARE MARKED · Speaking (each criterion = 25%)

Criterion	Band 7 sounds like...	Band 8–9 sounds like...
Fluency & Coherence	Speaks at length; some hesitation while searching for language	Hesitation is about ideas, not words; fully developed answers
Lexical Resource	Some idioms and less common words, with a few slips	Precise, natural vocabulary and idiomatic language
Grammatical Range & Accuracy	Mix of complex structures; frequent error-free sentences	Wide range used naturally; errors are rare
Pronunciation	Generally clear; some features of stress and intonation	Effortless to understand; natural rhythm and intonation

★ Model Part 2 answer (Band 8 level) – Mock 1 cue card

The hobby I'd like to talk about is cycling, which I've been into since I was about twelve. It started quite by chance: my uncle gave me his old mountain bike, and I got hooked on exploring the hills around my hometown. These days I'm doing a Master's degree, so I can't ride as often as I'd like, but I still manage a long ride most Saturdays, usually around forty kilometres. Why do I still enjoy it? Mainly because it's such a great outlet for stress. When I'm cycling, I can't check my phone or think about deadlines, so it forces me to switch off. It has also taught me patience: on a steep climb, there's no shortcut, you simply have to keep going. To be honest, I can't imagine giving it up.

Hobby language bank

Starting: take up, get into, pick up (a skill), give sth a go
Liking: be keen on, be passionate about, get a kick out of
Stopping: give up, lose interest in, drift away from
Types: outdoor pursuits, arts and crafts, team sports, collecting
Benefits: recharge my batteries, broaden my horizons, a sense of achievement

Extend every answer: A – R – E

Answer → Reason → Example.
 "Yes, I prefer team hobbies, (A) because I get bored easily on my own. (R)
 For example, I play five-a-side football with colleagues every Thursday." (E)

Pronunciation focus – word stress

HOB·by · LEI·sure · en·THU·si·ast · pho·TO·gra·phy · PHO·to·graph
 · re·LAX·ing · STRA·te·gy · stra·TE·gic · com·PE·ti·tive
 Tip: stress shifts in word families, e.g. PHOTograph → phoTOgrapher → photoGRAphic.

Buying time naturally

That's an interesting question; I've never really thought about it.
 Let me think... I'd probably say that...
 Well, it depends on what you mean by...
 Off the top of my head, I'd say...

Avoid these Band-6 habits

1. "My hobby is *listening music*" → listening **to** music.
2. Overusing "interesting" and "fun"; try *absorbing*, *rewarding*.
3. Stopping after 1 minute in Part 2; keep talking until stopped.
4. Mixing tenses: use present perfect for *since/for* (I've *played* for 5 years).

Part 2 one-minute plan

Write 4–5 key words, one per prompt, then add a **story** and a **feeling**:

What? cycling, mountain bike
When/how? age 12, uncle's gift
How much? Saturdays, 40 km
Why? stress outlet, patience

Score tracker

	FC	LR	GRA	P	Overall
Mock 1	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Mock 2	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____